



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

A TOXIC FIRE broke out at the Port of L.A. on Friday night. Residents were alerted about six hours later.

LONG DELAYS IN PORT BLAZE ALERTS

Warnings to shelter in place came hours after fire began. A status update was a day late.

By CLARA HARTER

The Los Angeles Fire Department waited nearly six hours after responding to a massive hazardous materials fire at the Port of L.A. on Friday before ordering residents to “get inside IMMEDIATELY and close all windows and doors” due to potential toxic smoke.

The department's shelter-in-place order for areas of San Pedro and Wilmington was then lifted at 6:30 a.m. Saturday as fire crews gained the upper hand on the stubborn blaze aboard cargo ship One Henry Hudson.

However, it wasn't until 8:58 p.m. Sunday — more than 38 hours after the order expired — that many residents received a series of alerts informing them the order had been lifted.

In addition, some residents in Rancho Palos Verdes reported erroneously receiving shelter-in-place alerts from the city of L.A.'s emergency alert system. The city of Rancho Palos Verdes released a statement via email and social media around 1:30 a.m. Saturday instructing residents to ignore the order.

[See Port fire, A7]

Behind the fall of Dr. Phil's media empire

The fortunes of America's celebrity therapist faded along with the market for syndicated TV

By Stacy Perman

It was not a good day for Dr. Phil. Phillip McGraw, the genial celebrity psychologist who spent a career calling out the behavior of others and doling out zingers, found himself upbraided by a bankruptcy judge.

Merit Street Media, McGraw's new network, had filed for bankruptcy protection in July, a little more than a year after he launched the media startup, and then sued its distribution partner, Trinity Broadcasting Network.

During a nearly three-hour hearing in Dallas last month, U.S. Bankruptcy Judge Scott Everett said that he'd “never seen a case” like the Chapter 11 filing McGraw's company was attempting.

Everett cited evidence indicating McGraw had “violated” a court order by deleting “unflattering” text messages that allegedly described his plan to use the bankruptcy to “wipe out” creditor claims.

“What makes this case unique, unfortunately, is that it has been plagued with the attempted destruction of relevant evidence and less than truthful testimony by some of the key players,” said Everett, alluding to McGraw and his associates in the case.

Everett ruled that Merit Street be liquidated.

Following the hearing, a spokesperson for McGraw's production company vigorously denied the [See Dr. Phil, A10]

U.S. moves put Venezuela on edge

Trump has ordered military buildup even as he says he's open to talks with Maduro.

By KATE LINTHICUM, PATRICK J. McDONNELL AND MERY MOGOLLÓN

CARACAS, Venezuela — On the face of it, the United States appears closer than ever to mounting a military campaign to remove President Nicolás Maduro from power in Venezuela.

President Trump says he has authorized the CIA to conduct covert operations inside the Caribbean nation, and has massed troops,

fighter jets and warships just off its coastline.

U.S. service members in the region have been barred from taking Thanksgiving leave. Airlines have canceled flights to Venezuela after the Federal Aviation Administration warned of a “potentially hazardous situation” there. And on Monday the White House officially designated Maduro as a member of an international terrorist group.

In Caracas, the nation's capital, there is a palpable sense of anxiety, especially as each new bellicose pronouncement emerges from Washington.

“People are very tense,” said Rosa María López, 47, a [See Venezuela, A4]



JUAN BARRETO AFP/Getty Images

PASSENGERS arrive in Maiquetia, Venezuela. Several airlines have canceled flights due to tensions.

Ukraine talks are fruitful, U.S says

By AAMER MADHANI, ISOBEL KOSHIW AND KONSTANTIN TOROPIN

WASHINGTON — President Trump said Tuesday his plan to end the war in Ukraine has been “fine-tuned” and he's sending envoy Steve Witkoff to meet with Russian President Vladimir Putin and Army Secretary Dan Driscoll to meet with Ukrainian officials.

He suggested he could eventually meet with Putin and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, but not until further progress has been made in negotiations.

“I will be briefed on all progress made, along with Vice President JD Vance, Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Secretary of War Pete Hegseth, and White House Chief of Staff Susie Wiles,” Trump added in the social media posting. “I look forward to hopefully meeting with President Zelensky and President Putin soon, but ONLY when the deal to end this War is FINAL or, in its final stages.”

Trump spoke after Driscoll held talks late Monday and throughout Tuesday with Russian officials in Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates, to discuss the emerging proposal.

“The talks are going well and we remain optimistic,” Lt. Col. Jeff Tolbert, spokesman for the Army secretary, said in a statement.

As the talks were taking place, Russia launched a [See Ukraine, A5]

Californians are sharply divided over ICE raids

Most Democratic voters oppose mass deportations, poll says. Not so in GOP.

By SEEMA MEHTA AND BRITTNY MEJIA

California voters are sharply divided along partisan lines over the Trump administration's immigration raids this year in Los Angeles and across the nation, according to a new poll.

Just over half of the state's registered voters oppose federal efforts to reduce undocumented immigration, and 61% are against deporting everyone in the nation who doesn't have legal status, according to the poll by UC Berkeley's Possibility Lab released to The Times on Wednesday.

But there is an acute difference in opinions based on political leanings.

Nearly 80% of Democrats oppose reducing the number of people entering the United States illegally, and

90% are against deporting everyone in the country who is undocumented, according to the poll. Among Republicans, 5% are against reducing the entries and 10% don't believe all undocumented immigrants should be forced to leave.

“The big thing that we find, not surprisingly, is that Democrats and Republicans look really different,” said political scientist Amy Lerman, director of the Possibility Lab, who studies race, public opinion and political behavior. “On these perspectives, they fall pretty clearly along party lines. While there's some variation within the parties by things like age and race, really, the big divide is between Democrats and Republicans.”

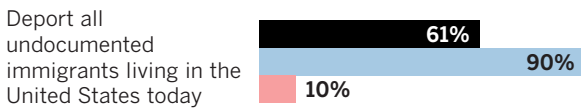
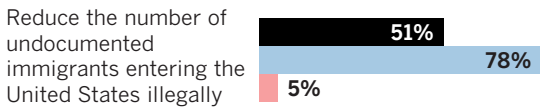
While there were some differences based on gender, age, income, geography and race, the results largely mirrored the partisan divide in the state, Lerman said.

One remarkable finding was that nearly a quarter of survey respondents personally knew or were acquainted with someone who [See Immigration, A7]

Split along party lines

California registered voters who oppose the current federal law enforcement effort to ...

■ Total ■ Democrats ■ Republicans



Poll conducted online in English and Spanish Oct. 20-27, among 8,141 registered voters in California.

The Possibility Lab survey fielded by the Berkeley IGS Poll

Los Angeles Times

She escaped fire; now red tape is threat

After Eaton blaze, navigating the recovery remains a struggle for a disabled mother

By Sonja Sharp



TED SOQUI For The Times

LUNA NEWMAN looks to mom Jessica while painting at the Splat studio in South Pasadena. They were displaced by the Eaton fire.

For months, Jessica Newman has jolted awake gasping in the darkness at 5 a.m., just as she did on Jan. 8. Early that morning, as the Santa Anas whipped at 90 mph, sheriff's deputies stormed through her Pasadena neighborhood ordering evacuations with flames at their heels.

Breathless as if the smoke still lingered, on a recent morning she bundled her effervescent 3-year-old daughter, Luna, into her car seat for the two-hour trek from her aunt's house in Riverside, where they have lived for much of the past year, back to their family's 1909 Craftsman home. It stands steps from the Eaton fire burn scar — untouched but uninhabitable.

“It's such an illusion,” Newman, 32, said of the home where she, her mother and her aunts all grew up. “The house looks so nice. You would never think there's so much damage.”

At first blush, Newman seems equally vital. But her heart is dying, the result of a rare and often fatal complication of pregnancy that disproportionately affects Black women.

After her diagnosis in 2022, her late grandmother's home became a refuge. The address [See Survivor, A8]

Trojans' season a step forward

If USC beats UCLA on Saturday, its nine wins would exceed expectations. **SPORTS, B10**

Body in car now a murder case

Police are investigating discovery of girl in the trunk of singer D4vd's Tesla. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

AI is minimized at iHeartMedia

DJs are expected to say “Guaranteed Human,” as part of on-air disclosures. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather

Mostly sunny, warm. L.A. Basin: 83/60. **B6**

Markets A11

Opinion Voices A12

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